

markpublish Quick Reference

Configuration and Templates

Reference for every key of markpublish.yaml and the building blocks of a theme.

Version	2.1.10
Date	2026-09-25
Author	Frank Winter
Copyright	© 2026 Frank Winter

markpublish.yaml

Top level: `document`, `theme`, `parts`, optionally `templates_dir`. All paths are relative to the directory of this file. Build with `markpublish build [CONFIG_FILE] [OPTIONS]`.

Structure

There are exactly two structural tiers. Anything deeper is carried by the Markdown file itself.

```
markpublish.yaml
├─ document:      metadata and global switches
├─ theme:         name of the theme
└─ parts:        list of sections
    └─ part:      name of the section
        └─ chapters: list of chapters
            └─ file: one Markdown file
                ├── # H1  chapter heading
                ├── ## H2  structure
                └── ### H3  inside the file
```

document

Metadata and global layout toggles. Only `title` is required.

Key	Default	Meaning
<code>title</code>	<i>required</i>	Document title (cover page, header, filename)
<code>subtitle</code>	–	Subtitle on the cover page
<code>summary</code>	–	Summary / abstract on the cover page
<code>author</code>	–	Author name
<code>date</code>	<code>auto</code>	Date (<code>auto</code> or <code>today</code> for the build date)
<code>version</code>	–	Version on the cover page and in the footer
<code>status</code>	–	Document status (e.g. <code>Draft</code> , <code>Approved</code>)
<code>copyright</code>	–	Copyright notice on the cover page
<code>language</code>	system language	ISO code for static labels (<code>de</code> , <code>en</code>)

Key	Default	Meaning
cover	false	Generate a cover page
header / footer	true	Running headers and footers
document_toc	full	Main table of contents: none, full or a depth
part_toc	full	Default for part divider pages: none, full or a depth
chapter_toc	full	Default for chapter divider pages: none, full or a depth
autonum_pattern	see <i>Numbering</i>	How numbers are built; slot 1 is the part here
autonum_reset	false	Levels below start again at one when entered
part_label	from i18n	Word before a part number (Part); "" drops it
chapter_label	from i18n	Word before a chapter number (Chapter); "" drops it
pagenum_reset	false	Restart page numbering per part or chapter

If the document consists of **exactly one chapter**, the main table of contents omits that chapter's own line: it would merely repeat the cover title, and an entry without siblings distinguishes nothing. The chapter's subheadings stay listed, and its number still appears above the text or on the divider page. `document_toc` still counts structural levels rather than visible lines: for two visible levels (H2 and H3), write `document_toc: 3`.

Custom fields under `document:` (`department: "R&D"`) reach the theme through the `meta` dictionary (`meta.at("department").value`). Static labels belong in `i18n.yaml`, not here.

parts

A part brackets chapters and passes settings down to them. Without `break_before` it does not show itself.

Key	Default	Meaning
part	<i>required</i>	Name of the section
chapters	<i>required</i>	List of chapters in this section
toc_title	part	Title in the main table of contents
divider_title	part	Title on the divider page
subtitle / summary	–	Subtitle and summary on the divider page
break_before	none	divider, page OR none

Key	Default	Meaning
document_toc	inherited	Contribution to the main TOC; <code>none</code> hides the part
part_toc	inherited	Local TOC on its own divider page
chapter_toc	inherited	Default for the divider pages of its chapters
autonum_pattern	inherited	Numbers of its chapters; slot 1 is the chapter here
autonum_reset	inherited	Chapters of this part start again at one
label	from i18n	Word before its own number
chapter_label	inherited	Word before the number of each of its chapters (Appendix)
pagenum_reset	inherited	Restart page numbering at the start of the part

chapters

A chapter is one Markdown file. Its name comes from that file's `#` heading.

Key	Default	Meaning
file	<i>required</i>	Path to the Markdown file
list_of	–	Instead of <code>file</code> : list of <code>figures</code> or <code>tables</code> at this position
show_title	<code>true</code>	Show the file's H1 on the content page
toc_title	file H1	Title in the table of contents and running header
divider_title	file H1	Title on the divider page
subtitle / summary	–	Subtitle and summary on the divider page
break_before	<code>page</code>	<code>divider</code> , <code>page</code> OR <code>none</code>
document_toc	inherited	Contribution to the main TOC (<code>none</code> , <code>full</code> , <code>depth</code>)
chapter_toc	inherited	Local TOC on its own divider page
autonum_pattern	inherited	Numbers <i>inside</i> the chapter; slot 1 is the H2 here
autonum_reset	inherited	Headings of this chapter start again at one
label	inherited	Word before its own number (Appendix A: ...)
pagenum_reset	inherited	Restart page numbering at the start of the chapter

Inheritance

Everything marked *inherited* flows from the outside in; the innermost setting wins.

document	→	parts[]	→	chapters[]
autonum_pattern		autonum_pattern		autonum_pattern
autonum_reset		autonum_reset		autonum_reset
document_toc		document_toc		document_toc
part_toc		part_toc		-
chapter_toc		chapter_toc		chapter_toc
pagenum_reset		pagenum_reset		pagenum_reset
part_label		label		-
chapter_label		chapter_label		label

Numbering

A pattern describes the levels *below* the place it stands — so slot 1 shifts with that place.

Level	under document	on a part	on a chapter
Part	slot 1	-	-
Chapter (H1)	slot 2	slot 1	-
H2	slot 3	slot 2	slot 1
H3	slot 4	slot 3	slot 2
⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮
H6	slot 7	slot 6	slot 5

Symbols: 1 → 1, 2, 3 · 01 → 01, 02 · a / A → a, b / A, B · i / I → i, ii / I, II · _ level without a number · + repeats the slot before it for every deeper level. Slots are separated by |; everything else in a slot is a literal, reserved characters go in single quotes ('Article '1').

on document	"_ 1 .1 +"	part unnumbered · chapter 1 · 1.1
on document	"_ _ 1 .1 +"	single-chapter document: H2 becomes
1., 2., 3.		
on document	"I 1 .1 +"	Part I · chapters 1, 2, 3 through
on a part	"A .1 +"	chapter A · A.1 · A.1.1
on a part	"'Article '1 ' ('1')'"	Article 1 · Article 1 (2)

Without a setting, "_|1|.1|+" applies: parts unnumbered, chapters 1, 1.1, 1.1.1.

The part number does **not** enter the chapter numbers; a part with document_toc: "none" gets none and consumes none. A notated label steps in front of the heading's number (Appendix A: Schema) without reaching the subheadings (A.1).

Templates and Themes

Everything visible is controlled by a theme: typography, page layout, and static text. The built-in default theme `default` is provided for PDF.

Where Themes Are Located

The first match wins — a theme is always loaded from exactly one source location and never merged across multiple locations. Which theme is used is determined by the `--theme` command-line option or the `theme:` setting in `markpublish.yaml` (default: `default`).

Rank	Location
1. User	<code>~/.markpublish/templates/<theme>/</code> or user-specific AppData directory
2. Project	<code>--templates-dir</code> on CLI, <code>templates_dir:</code> in YAML, <code>MARKPUBLISH_TEMPLATES_DIR</code> , or <code>./templates/<theme>/</code>
3. Package	Built-in standard theme <code>default</code>

`markpublish templates` lists all templates available on the system along with their resolution rank and origin.

Customizing a Theme

```
markpublish export-template default ./templates
```

This command copies the built-in theme files into your project directory, where resolution rank 2 automatically discovers and uses them on the next build. For PDF output, a theme directory contains:

- `template.typ`: Main Typst layout template defining page geometry, headers, footers, and styles
- `i18n.yaml`: Shared label definitions and localized strings across the theme
- `pdf/i18n.yaml`: Format-specific label definitions and string overrides for PDF
- `fonts/`: Optional custom font files (.ttf, .otf) loaded by Typst
- `assets/`: Image assets, logos, and vector icons

Static Labels (i18n)

Labels resolve through a four-stage cascade; a lower level overrides only the keys it explicitly defines:

Level	File
1. Application	markpublish/i18n.yaml (application default strings)
2. Theme	<templates>/<theme>/i18n.yaml
3. Target format	<templates>/<theme>/pdf/i18n.yaml
4. Project	./i18n.yaml next to markpublish.yaml

Each file is organized by language code (de:, en:); the key "*" applies to all languages. Level 4 belongs to the project: it allows overriding labels and localizing custom metadata fields (department: "Department"). Use markpublish labels --overridden or markpublish labels --theme <theme> to inspect the cascade before building.

Key CLI Commands

Command	Key Options	Description
markpublish build	--theme, --target, -o, --templates-dir	Compile document to PDF
markpublish init	[TARGET], --title, --lang	Set up a minimal starter project
markpublish cheatsheet	--lang, --theme, -o, --templates-dir	Generate this quick reference as PDF
markpublish manual	--lang, --theme, -o, --templates-dir	Generate the complete user manual
markpublish templates	--target, --templates-dir	List templates and lookup rank
markpublish export-template	[THEME], [TARGET], --target	Export template files for customization
markpublish labels	--theme, --target, --templates-dir, --overridden	Inspect static labels and metadata